

Figure 5: Circle effect

and choose the *Alpha to Selection* option. Notice that the concentric circles become actively selected. The next step is to fill them with colour. We need to fill colour in between their boundaries. To do so, navigate to *Select→Invert*. Fill the selection with white colour using the *Bucket fill* or simply drag the white swatch over the selection.

Right now the circle looks a bit plain, so we will add a shadow to it. The GIMP has a pre-built 'drop shadow' plug-in. Just right click on the Lower Left Big Circle layer, select *Alpha to Selection* and navigate to *Filters→Light and Shadow→Drop Shadow*. A new dialogue box will pop up. Set the X and Y values to 0 and leave the blur radius intact. Once you have provided the drop shadow, you will notice a few transparent parts added. To remove them, just right-click the *Background* layer, select *Alpha to Selection* and crop it using *Image→Crop to Selection*.

The next step is to merge the drop shadow layer. To achieve this, just drag the drop shadow layer above the Lower Left Big Circle layer and select the *'Merge down'* option by right-clicking on the drop shadow layer. Once done, lower the opacity to 40.

Step 8 To achieve a bit of a cartoon-like effect, we will make concentric circles. We need not repeat Step 7 every time. You do remember that we are working on one of the most powerful image editors, right? So, just duplicate the Lower Left Big Circle layer and rename it Lower Left Mid Circle. Resize the layer using Scale Tool from the toolbox (or press *Shift+T*) and make a smaller circle. Use the move tool (m) to move the mid-circle inside the big circle. Continue repeating the step until you have achieved the effect as shown in Figure 5 - Part 6.

I first thought of introducing only the primordial selection tool but later thought I'd add the path tool as well. Don't worry—the path tool work in this tutorial is just to get you familiar with it. We will work with the path tool more extensively in the upcoming tutorials.

The next step will guide you in spicing up the bottom right portion of the image.

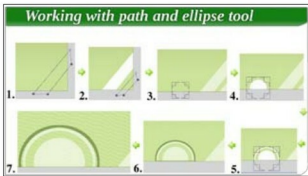


Figure 6: Right side effect

Step 9 So, let's get on with the path tool. Create yet another layer and label it 'Right Line'. Grab the path tool from the toolbox or press *B*. Once done, make an inclined shape as shown in Figure 6 (part1). Just keep making dots and complete the selection. To join the two dots, right at the end, hold *Ctrl* and click the nearby dot to complete the selection. Press *Enter* to make the selection active. You will be fretting that I have taken the path outside the canvas. Don't worry, the path tool is very intelligent and will only create a selection inside the canvas. So if you have very little space to work with inside, don't hesitate to exploit the outer territory.

Once you have completed the selection, fill it with white colour and continue making smaller siblings as shown in Figure 6 - Part 2. Fill them as well and reduce the opacity to 60. You can always vary the opacity and the ways to create your own effect, but for this tutorial we will work in a proper manner.

The wallpaper looks a bit simple, doesn't it? So how do we spice it up? Let's add some bubble-like circles to it. We will try to keep it simple with no jazzy effects, as of now.

Step 10 So we are going to add some bubbles. We will work in multiple bubble layers to ease the work. Create a new transparent layer and rename it *Bubbles*. Grab the *Ellipse selection* tool and create a semicircle at the horizon of the wallpaper as shown in Figure 6 - Part 3. Fill it with white colour. Now create a bigger selection, as shown in Figure 6 - Part 4, and navigate to *Edit→Stroke Selection* and stroke the outer part with the line width value set to 6. Deselect by *Select→None*.

The final part is to create another ellipse just above the outer ellipse's border. Note that we have to create a selection just above the previous one so that they look very close and glued together. The newer line should not overlap the previous white line.

Once you have set the foreground colour to #496623, stroke the newly created selection with a line width of 6. This completes the bubble part. You